First programs: print, variables and input



Programming · Level 2 · Lesson 1

Today we will

- Predict what a short program shows, then run it.
- Tell text in quotes from numbers.
- Say what a variable holds after it changes.

Remember

- Python runs one line at a time, top to bottom.
- print("7 * 6") shows 7 * 6; print(7 * 6) shows 42.
- = stores a value: pupils = pupils + 2 adds 2.

Predict, then run

1. Warm-up (5 min): What is a program? Give a robot instructions.
2. Teach (10 min): print, quotes and variables on the board.
3. Predict (10 min): Pairs write what three programs will show.
4. Run (10 min): Run each one on the phone; read out the results.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which prediction was wrong, and why? Exit ticket.

One phone is enough: run the programs yourself and read the results aloud, or pass the phone to the pair who predicted best. Download the lesson the day before, so Python works without a connection.

Let’s discuss

1. Why does print("5" + "3") show 53?
2. How can pupils = pupils + 2 make sense?
3. What job could a short program do for our class?

Exit ticket

- Write a two-line program and what it will show.